Nick Jacobson

Carter Luellen

Sophia Schwantes

Zander Burns

150 W. University Blvd.

Melbourne, FL 32901

December 4th, 2023

Professor Gonzalez

Florida Institute of Technology

150 W. University Blvd.

Melbourne, FL 32901

Dear Professor Gonzalez,

This report details our research into the communicative standards between administration at the Florida Institute of Technology and its students. The methodology to obtain this data, as well as the resulting conclusions and recommendations for improvements on this topic are enclosed inside. We appreciate your consideration.

Respectfully, ACE - Group 3

ACE

Active Communication Efficiencies

Administrative Communicative Standards at the Florida Institute of Technology

Active Communication Efficiencies

A Recommendation Report

Administrative Communicative Standards at the Florida Institute of Technology

Active Communication Efficiencies

Prepared For:

Professor Stephanie Gonzalez

Sci/Tech Communications

Florida Institute of Technology

150 W. University Blvd.

Melbourne, FL 32901

Prepared By:

Nick Jacobson

Carter Luellen

Sophia Schwantes

Zander Burns

December 6th, 2023

Abstract -

This study outlines communication issues between universities and their counterparts and proposes solutions to minimize complications. Complications in universities arise from several factors, including sending time-sensitive information in non-preferred formats or an overload of communication technology used disorderly, along with frequent campus rearrangements. This study brainstormed several solutions to help universities improve communication with students and administration.

Keywords: Digital communication, universities, students and faculty, stress, anxiety, technology, college

Table of Contents -

Executive Summary

..... iii

Introduction .....

1

Research Methods .....

1

Task 1 – Secondary Research ….....

7

1.1 - Lack of Communication between College Students & Faculty 7

1.2 - Communication Preferences for Students ….....

7

1.3 - Overutilization of Applications in Universities 8

1.4 - Disordered College Campus Layouts ….....

9

Task 2 – Primary Research ….....

10

2.1 - Questionnaire Demographics ….....

10

2.2 - Student Opinion on General Administrative Communication ….....

11

2.3 - Student Data on Administrative Email System .....

12

2.4 - Student Application Use and Preferences .....

15

Task 3 – Conclusion ….....

20

3.1 - Email Communication Conclusions .....

20

3.2 - Application Overuse Conclusions .....

21

3.3 – General Administrative Communication Conclusions

…… 22

Task 4 – Recommendations

……..... 23

Task 5 – Conclusions

……..... 25

Appendix A: Fall 2023 Student Classification of Representative Student Population at FIT ….....

26

Appendix B: Fall 2023 Student Opinion on Time-Sensitive Administrative Communication at FIT ….....

27

Appendix C: Fall 2023 Student Perspective on General Communication at FIT .....

28

Appendix D: Fall 2023 Student Opinion of Administrative Email Problems at FIT ….....

29

Appendix E: Fall 2023 Student Opinion on General Email Communication at FIT ….....

30

Appendix F: Fall 2023 Frequency that Students Check Their Emails at FIT ….....

31

Appendix G: Fall 2023 Student Percent Application Usage at FIT ….....

32

Appendix H: Student Preference of Application for Time-Sensitive .....

33

Appendix I: Empty Decision Matrix .....

34

Appendix J: Decision Matrix .....

35

Appendix K: Meeting Minutes .....

36

Appendix L: References .....

49

Appendix M: Glossary .....

52

Appendix N: Gantt Chart .....

53

Executive Summary –

The primary focus of this report is to address the multitude of issues within digital communication systems used by administrators at FIT. The research methodology encompassed both secondary and primary approaches. Secondary research was used to gain a basic understanding of the common problems that are experienced by users of college communication portals. This information was then used to develop a questionnaire that was distributed to students at FIT. The questionnaire revealed that the majority of students perceived problems in the student email system, ranging from cluttered inboxes to misleading email titles. When presented with three options, Notably, 47.2% of the student body advocated for additional functionalities in the CANVAS application to enhance accessibility of information from the administrative body to students. Students also expressed a variety of opinions within short response questions, where the most common ones were categorized to be incorporated within the decision matrix. To arrive at a solution, a decision matrix was employed comparing three suggested solutions against each other. The outcome favored a three-step program as the most effective approach to address communication challenges at FIT. The recommended three-step program involves augmenting CANVAS with administrative notifications, revising the quantity and wording of emails, and introducing a SMS texting system for administrators to communicate with students efficiently and promptly reach students. This three-step approach aims to resolve the identified communication issues at FIT.

Introduction -

There are significant communication issues among universities, students, and faculty (Gray, 2021). These miscommunications result in unnecessary mental tension, leading to anxiety and stress for students and faculty due to unclear and inconvenient communication methods (Ludwig, 2023). While technology and media have seen exponential growth, universities have adopted various tools to enhance communication, sometimes resulting in excessive programs and disorganized communication (Wiyono, 2020). From reviewing scholarly articles and papers and conducting a questionnaire for Florida Institute of Technology students, this study addresses these miscommunication issues and proposes solutions to improve communication between university administration and students. This paper will cover the methods used in this study, as well as the following tasks.

Task 1 provides an overview of the research plan:

- Task 1.1: Identifies the current communication issues through a secondary research article. This study recognizes the urgency of addressing communications within universities and puts forth a practical solution through the promotion of out of class communication. By cultivating heightened interest and engagement in OCC, the goal is to create a more streamlined and effective communication system that not only benefits students but also enhances the overall educational experience for both students and faculty alike.
- Task 1.2: Focuses on email-related problems and suggests solutions. This article puts emphasis on recognizing the evolving landscape of student communication preferences, where there is a clear need for higher education institutions to adapt their methods. This piece of secondary research suggests incorporating an SMS texting system for urgent alerts to provide a more

effective and immediate means of reaching students, ensuring that important information is both received and acted upon in a timely manner.

- Task 1.3: Examines software-related communication challenges and provides solutions. This secondary research article highlights the challenges of digital communication within universities. The article expresses the need for careful handling of various communication platforms. The research in this article found that out of 43 tested digital communication platforms, only 15 achieved an effectiveness score of 50% or higher. Notably, widely used platforms like the Google search engine, email, and Google Classroom were identified as the most effective for learning and communication.
- Task 1.4: Investigates physical university infrastructure issues and proposes a solution called *Wayfinder*. This article highlights how overwhelming arriving at a new campus can be, particularly for newcomers facing the challenges of vast college spaces, outdated information, and perpetual campus developments. The disorganization creates stress and confusion for students and staff alike. This study highlighted that a significant portion of higher education leaders prioritize renovations and modernization, underscoring the dynamic nature of campus layouts. In response to these challenges, *Wayfinder* emerges as a solution—a program offering an interactive college map through the library website. *Wayfinder* aims to alleviate confusion caused by staff and office changes, enhance the online directory, and execute plans based on interactive data collection. By providing an up-to-date and precise campus map, *Wayfinder* not only aids the campus community but also benefits visitors, ultimately reducing the stress associated with navigating a new environment.

Task 2 provides an overview of the primary research that ACE conducted.

- Task 2.1: Outlines the limitations of the questionnaire that was taken by Florida Institute of Technology students, the biggest of which being that lack of responses.

- Task 2.2: Displays the questionnaire demographics of Florida Tech students that participated in the survey.
- Task 2.3: Outlines the general student opinion on administrative communication from the survey conducted at Florida Institute of Technology. This section investigated student opinions on administrative communication, emphasizing effectiveness, quality, and timeliness. The findings, detailed in Figures 2 and 3, offer insights into student perspectives. Recommendations for improvement include addressing email overload and enhancing clarity in email communication. Conversely, students appreciate the reliability and consistency of communication channels, notably citing email and CANVAS as effective means of contact. The survey provides valuable feedback on the state of administrative communication at FIT, outlining areas for enhancement and acknowledging positive aspects.
- Task 2.4: This section sought student opinions on issues related to administrative email usage from the survey at Florida Institute of Technology. Students were presented with options to choose from regarding problems with administrative emails. The survey also gauged general opinions on the effectiveness of email communication at FIT and the frequency at which students check their emails. The results, detailed in Figures 4, 5, and 6, provide valuable insights into student perspectives on administrative communication and email practices at FIT.
- Task 2.5: This section goes over the portion of the survey at Florida Institute of Technology that assessed students' utilization of various applications offered by the institution. Students were asked to indicate which applications they have used, and the results, detailed in Figures 7 and 8, provide insights into the popularity and preferences regarding these applications. Understanding the applications that students commonly use and their preferred channels for time-sensitive information can inform communication strategies and enhance overall effectiveness at FIT.

Task 3 provides an analysis of the data collected from the survey conducted at Florida Institute of Technology to identify the central issue regarding communication between students and administrators.

- Task 3.1: This section outlines the email communication results concluded from the survey conducted at FIT. Initially, the problem was seen as communication issues between students and the administration at FIT. Now, it's clearer that the main concerns are not with using email itself, but with how it's used. Many students feel there are too many unnecessary and excessive emails, causing frustration for those who check their emails regularly. The suggestion is to take a closer look at how the email system is used and find ways to fix the problems identified.
- Task 3.2: This section of the report investigates the use of applications at FIT and reveals the notable issue. All surveyed students use CANVAS, and a majority have engaged with various other applications. The prevalence of multiple applications, each involving cross-communication from administration, faculty, and staff, suggests disorganized communication processes. The report highlights the need to streamline and integrate certain applications for more effective communication.
- Task 3.3: This section of the report delves into the topic of communication, specifically focusing on administrative communication at FIT. The report evaluates general opinions and data regarding administrative communication at FIT.

Task 4 provides an overview of ACE decisions on the implementation of a solution to improve communication between students and administration. This section goes into detail about how and why ACE came to the solution, including Figure 10, the decision matrix. This section also covers the implementation process.

Task 5 provides a summary of the overall paper.

Methods -

Task 1 discusses our secondary research illustrating miscommunication problems across colleges in the United States of America and introduce several solutions. The research collected came from peer-reviewed scholarly articles, journals, and reliable news articles (Appendix A). All secondary research began on September 11 and will be completed by the end of the final week of November 2023.

The research obtained throughout section 2 was acquired through a questionnaire created directly by the team and distributed to undergraduate and graduate students throughout the Florida Institute of Technology. The questionnaire consists of 11 total questions, 9 of which are multiple choice and 2 fill in the blank questions.

***Figure 1**: Blank Decision Matrix*

Criteria and Weight		Options					
		SMS Texting System		3-Step System		Wayfinder	
Criterion	Weight	Rating	Score	Rating	Score	Rating	Score
Student Preference	3						
Ease of Use	1						
Ease of Implementation	2						
Total							

In order to choose which of our solutions was best, we used something known as a decision matrix. The decision matrix acts as a voting system that compares each solution to a series of criterion. At the end of the voting cycle, whichever has the most total score wins.

Starting with the criterion, these criteria were chosen in order to gauge the strengths and weaknesses of each considered solution. The “Student Preference” category measures how well each group member thinks a given solution would match with the opinions expressed within the questionnaire. The “Ease of

Use” category measures how easy and/or familiar a given solution would feel to the student body. Finally, the “Ease of Implementation" category measures how well a given solution can be implemented based on factors such as cost effectiveness and timeliness.

Each criterion was assigned a given “weight” value. This value refers to how important a particular criterion is. The higher the “weight” value is, the more important that criteria is. The “Student Preference” criteria was given a value of 3, which is the highest value that was given to a criterion. We chose this because we think it is detrimental that this new method of student-admin communication is based upon what the student body believes is best. Second, we assigned a weight value of 2 to the “Ease of Implementation” category. We made this decision due to the fact that re-working a system as large as the one in place for current FIT campus communication is both complicated and expensive. Placing this category second ensures that both the financial and laborious burden of this task occurs without difficulty and is cost effective as to not impact the financial security of the institute. Lastly, the “Ease of Use” category was given a weight value of 1, as all of the solutions that were to be voted upon were seen as already fairly straight forward, and this criterion more so measures how easy they are to use in comparison to one another.

The “Rating” value shows how well each group member believed a given solution matched a given criteria on a scale of 1-10. The “Score” value was calculated by multiplying the “rating” value by the “weight” value (weight * rating = score).

Finally, the “Options” area of the decision matrix shows our 3 solutions that we are voting on. The “SMS Texting System” refers to a system in which administrators can send out text messages to the student body. The “3-Step System” refers to a system that includes new admin infrastructure added into the CANVAS application, and SMS texting system for administrators to utilize, and a re-work on how the

student email system is handled at FIT. Finally, the "Wayfinder" option refers to the introduction of a new application specifically for admin alerts.

Results -

1.1 - The Lack of Communication between College Students & Faculty

The lack of effective communication between college students and school faculty remains an issue in higher education, impacting all ranges of student's overall academic experience. 39% of students agreed that poor and ineffective communication is shared between teachers and students, and 44% agreed that it was a cause of poor performances for students in Economics for Leaders (EFL) programs (Albalawi and Nadeem). In addition, communication problems are found in varied departments within university settings revealed significant communication problems in work-related and off-campus contexts in varying departments (Gizir and Simsek). 148 students and 35 instructors were measured for their overall interest and engagement in out-of-class communication (OCC). It addresses a solution to the issue of communication between students and administrators. Examining and comparing the participants' interests and engagements in OCC shed light on this issue. This is a solution for miscommunication within the universities by using OCC and allowing students to contact faculty and other departments rather than poor emails, many miscommunications, and confusing information (Kuryan and Voronina).

1.2 - Communication Preferences for Students

Email has been the primary method of online communication between most colleges and their students over the last decade, however that may not be the best way to reach out to students concerning important matters (Pate et at. 2022). Students have different preferences regarding how they received information from their campuses depending on what information is being given to them (Pate et at. 2022). For information that was not time sensitive, it was found that 84% of students polled preferred

email. When it came to information that was time sensitive, only 19% preferred email, with the majority preferring either in-person disclosure, or a text message (Pate et at. 2022). On college campuses, emails are often filled with information about classes, assignments, construction updates, meeting opportunities, and an infinite number of other topics. This can make it extremely overwhelming for students both old and new to find information that needs to be addressed within a timely manner. Two ways this issue could be addressed is by incorporating an SMS texting system specifically for urgent alerts and information, or alternatively an app used for the same purpose (Henion, 2021). An SMS texting system, known also as a short message system, would be the most ideal to solve this problem, as 98% of text messages are eventually opened, and 90% are opened within 3 minutes of reception (Henion, 2021).

1.3 - Overutilization of Applications in Universities

Although digital communication within universities is less effective than direct communication it can still have its undeniable benefits, but those benefits can turn into detriments if not handled correctly (Wiyono et al., 2019). The usage of too many digital communication platforms within college can lower their overall effectiveness and the quality of platform chosen is important. Of 43 digital communication platforms tested within university only 15 managed an effectiveness score of 50% or higher (Wiyono et al., 2020). The most used media, that of the Google search engine, email and Google classroom also were linked to being the most effective learning and communication media inside college (Wiyono, et al., 2020). The most effective communication platforms also happen to be some of the most established and understood with Google classroom being released in 2014, the Google search engine in 1998 and email becoming widely used by 1976 (Umass.edu; About.google; Spevack, 1999). Limiting the communication software by using a 3-software system could solve this problem (Musheke, Phiri, 2022). The first software utilized would be email for communication between students and administration. The second software would be *CANVAS* learning software, for students' coursework; and faculty communication

finally, the third software being *Short Message Service* (SMS), better known as texting, for communication between students and university staff regarding non-course related topics (Wiyono et al., 2020). Separating the communication between students, faculty, and admin into 3 sectors can help to prevent unnecessary clutter and accidental cross communication. This 3-software system could be difficult to implement into an entire university due to its lack of flexibility. This solution could have problems with accounting for unexpected circumstances, such as a website or program outage. This solution also does not account for potential electronic limitations of international colleges. Still, this could prove to be an effective solution to the current communication problems.

1.4 - Disordered College Campus Layouts

For most new students and staff, arriving at a new campus is an overwhelming experience (Ludwig, 2023). This is especially apparent considering that even small colleges and universities can span several acres. For a newcomer, this experience can be intimidating and cause anxiety and stress (Ludwig, 2023). This is especially true when information on building and office whereabouts is limited or outdated, with seemingly perpetual campus developments that physical maps and signs cannot keep up with (Wesel, 2021). One study showed that 33% of thought leaders in higher education prioritized “renovations and modernization” as the focus for their institutions, demonstrating the constant shifts in building layouts and offices (Wesel, 2021). These factors emphasize the demand for an up-to-date server that provides specific locations of buildings and offices on college campuses. One program presented as a solution is Wayfinder, an interactive college map implemented through the college or university’s library website (Agrawal et al. 2014). This server aims to aid in several ways, including but not limited to:

1. Easing the confusion of frequent staff and office changes for both students and faculty
2. Assisting in a more cohesive and comprehensible online directory
3. The execution of plans from which data is collected interactively from students and staff.

Wayfinder intends to help not just students, staff, and faculty but also anyone visiting the campus by creating an interactive campus map that any audience can utilize. This, in turn, helps alleviate some of the stressors of navigating a new environment by saving time and confusion with precise campus locations.

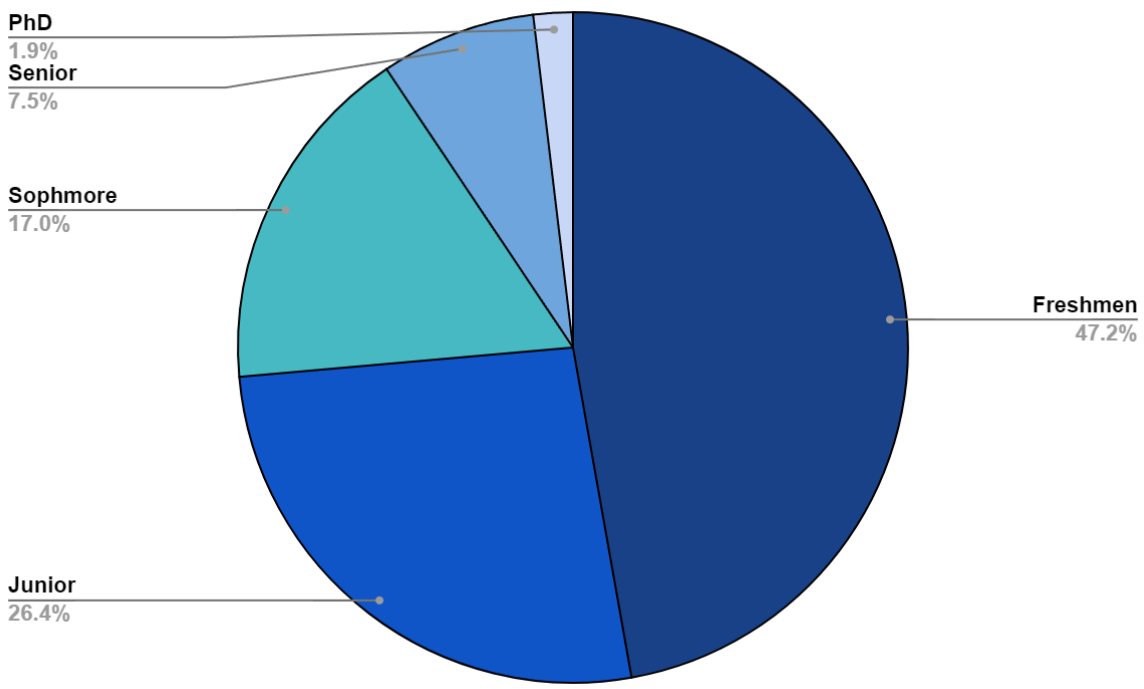
2.1 - Questionnaire Responses

The data used in this section came from a representative data pool consisting of 54 students at various stages of academia. The ideal representative data pool Group 3 hoped to achieve was a total student response of 380 or higher. At the conclusion and closure of the questionnaire a total of 54 student responses were received. This is only 14% of the representative student population goal. This significant lack of responses does not generate an accurate representation of the total student opinion at Florida Institute of Technology. This represents a limitation within the primary data.

2.2 - Questionnaire Demographics

The pie chart below shows the classification of all students that participated in the questionnaire.

Figure 2: *Fall 2023 Student Classification of Representative Student Population at FIT*



Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

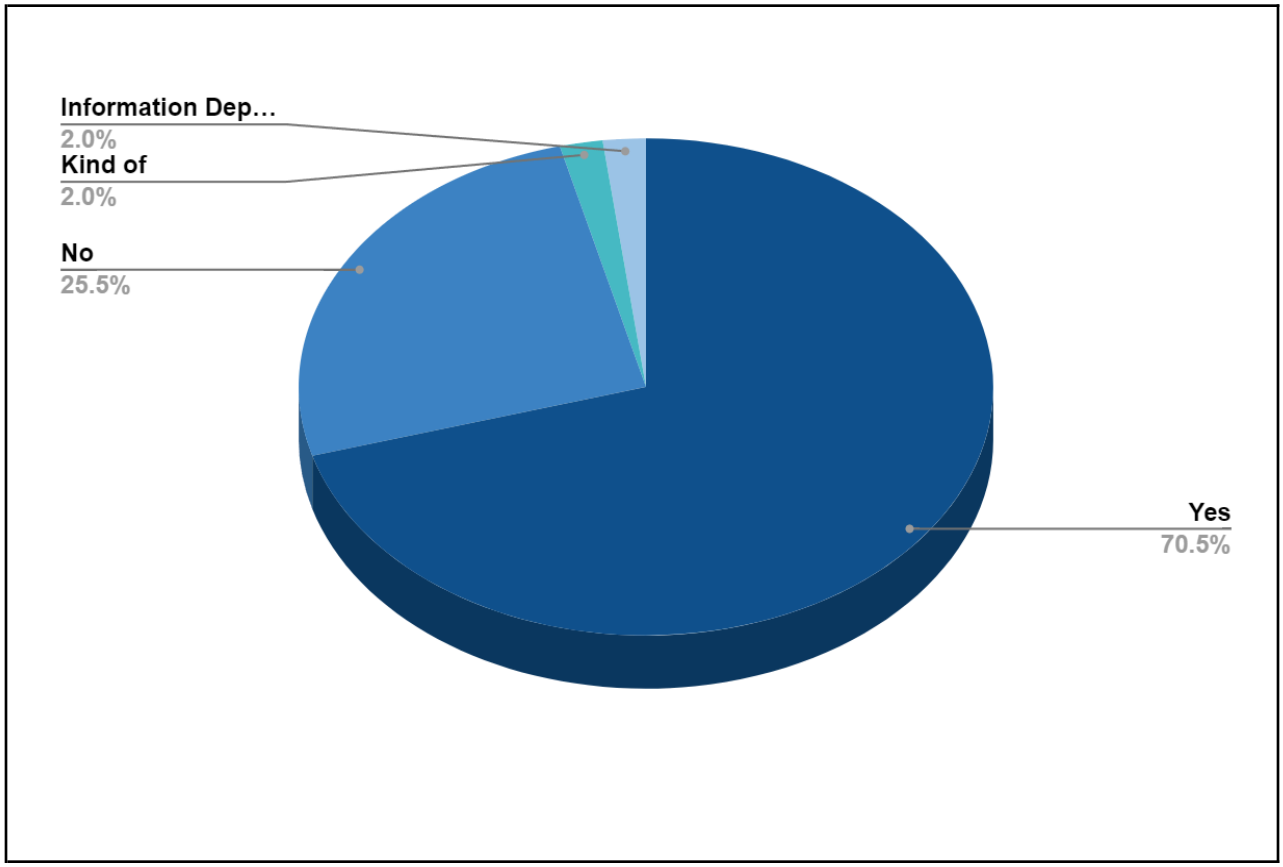
Nearly half of all respondents, 47.2%, for the questionnaire were freshmen to the Florida Institute of Technology. The next highest percentage of respondents were Juniors at 26.4%. Sophomores represented only 17% of respondents and seniors at 7.5%. Less than 2% of respondents were above the undergraduate level with 1.9% being PhD students.

2.3 - Student Opinion on General Administrative Communication

Some questions in the questionnaire asked students' opinions on the effectiveness, quality, and timeliness of administrative communication to the students themselves. The results below are indicative of the student opinion.

Figure 3: *Fall 2023 Student Opinion on Time-Sensitive Administrative Communication at FIT*

The PI chart below displays students' simple opinion on the current effectiveness and sufficiency of time-sensitive administrative communication.

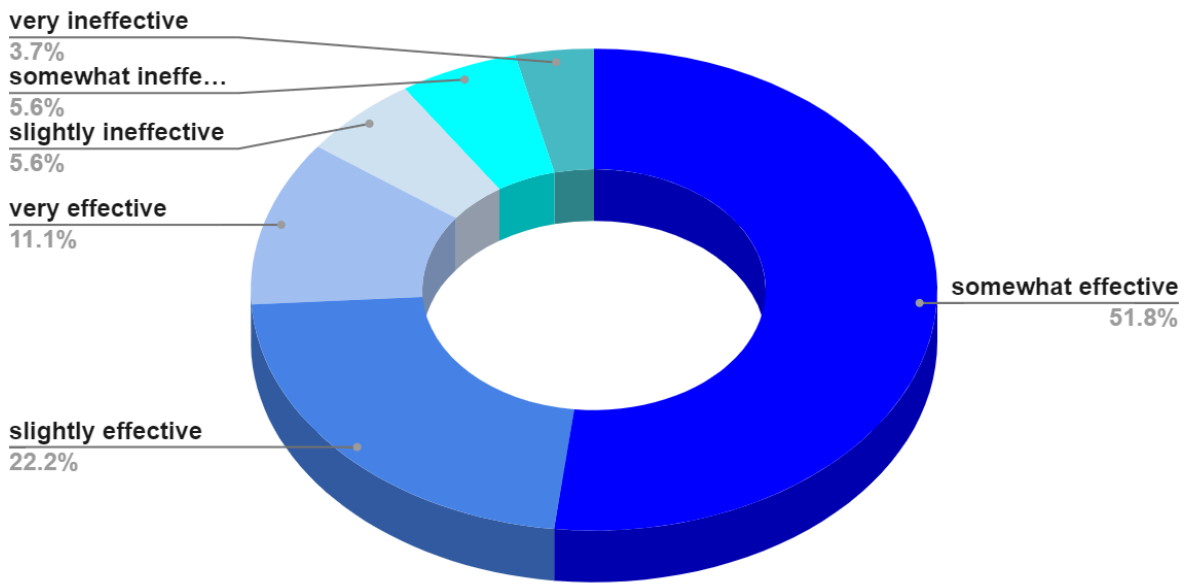


Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

This question followed a simple yes, no or kind of structure to first understand the general opinion of the sample student population. 70.5% of students agreed that time-sensitive information was communicated adequately by administration. 25.5% of students believed time-sensitive subjects are not effectively communicated by administration. Only 4% of students believed the quality and timeliness of time-sensitive administrative communication varied.

Figure 4: *Fall 2023 Student Perspective on General Communication at FIT*

The next graph below displays students' opinions of the effectiveness of general communication within the Florida Institute of Technology.



Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Graph 3 above shows students' general opinion on the effectiveness of communication at the Florida Institute of Technology. 51.8% of students believed general communication at the Florida Institute of Technology is somewhat effective. The next highest percentage, at 22.2% of students believe general communication at FIT is slightly effective. 11.1% of students believe general communication is very effective. Slightly ineffective and somewhat ineffective both saw an equal 5.6% of student votes. Very ineffective had only 3.7% of students vote for the option.

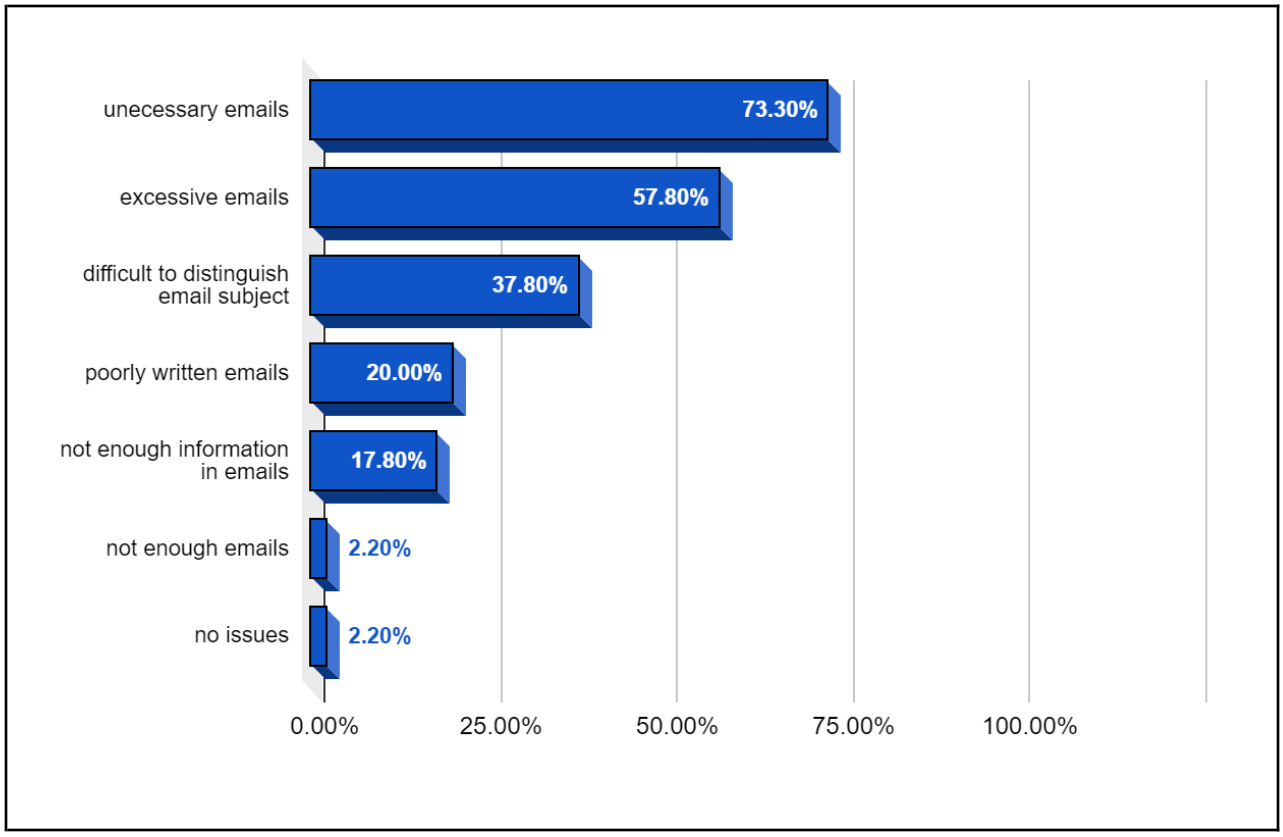
When students were asked what they specifically would improve about current administrative communication one student had this to say: “less 'spam' emails that clutter inboxes, teachers/administration don't even see students’ emails at times because of this.” Another student also added: “Clearer email headings and less unimportant emails. Perhaps there is a way to distinguish significant emails from insignificant ones.” Students were also asked what they liked most about administrative communication. One student claimed: “I like how email and CANVAS are the most reliable way to contact the people with the speed of being able to connect to them.” Another student simply said, “That it is consistent.”

2.4 - Student Data on Administrative Email System

Students were given the option to choose from a list of potential issues they found with the current administrative utilization of email. The data below comes directly from the results of the questionnaire.

Figure 5: *Fall 2023 Student Opinion of Administrative Email Problems at FIT*

The Bar graph Below shows students' opinions on the biggest problems present in administrative emails. Students had the ability to choose up to all options or none.



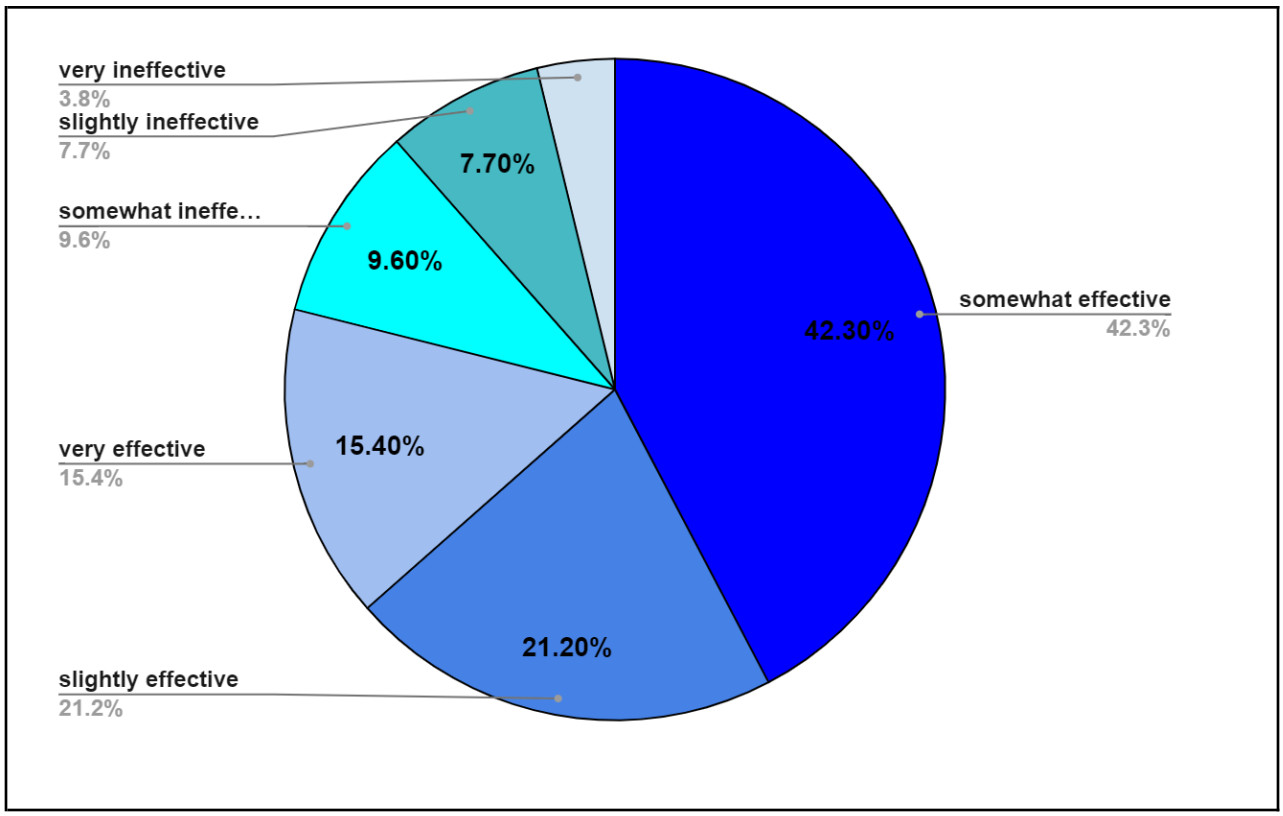
Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

A large 73.3% of students believed that administration sends too many unnecessary emails. 57.8% of students believe administration sends an excessive number of emails which correlates to the high

percentage of students believing there are too many unnecessary emails. 37.8% of students believe the subject matter of administrative emails is difficult to distinguish. 20% of students believe administrative emails are poorly written. Only 17.8% of students believe administrative emails lack enough details. Only 2.2% of students believe that there are not enough emails from administration. An equal 2.2% of students believe that there are no administrative email issues.

Figure 6: *Fall 2023 Student Opinion on General Email Communication at FIT*

Graph 5 below shows students' opinion on the effectiveness of general email communication at the Florida Institute of Technology.

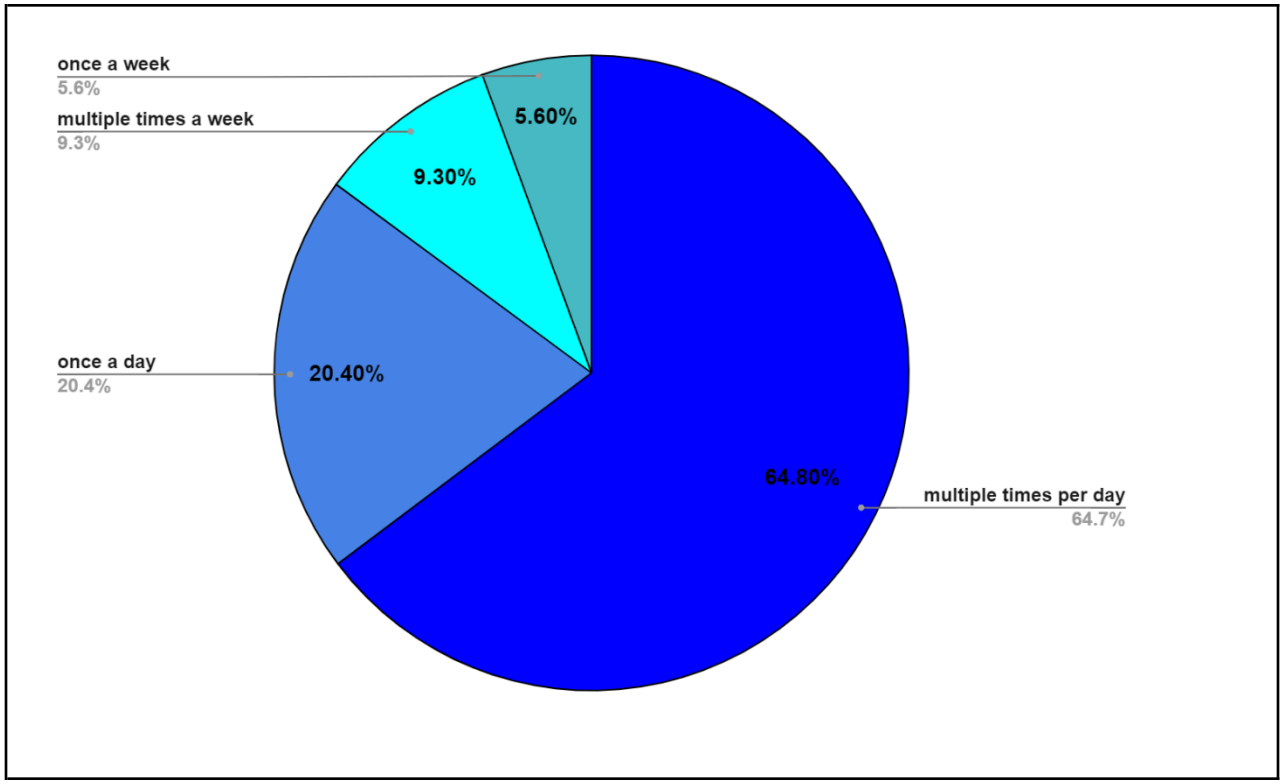


Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

42.3% of students believed general email communication at the Florida Institute of Technology is somewhat effective. 21.2% of students believe general email communication at FIT is slightly effective. 15.4% of students voted that general email communication is very effective. 9.6% of students voted that general email communication is somewhat ineffective. 7.7% of students believed email communication at the Florida Institute of Technology is slightly ineffective. Only 3.8% of students voted that email communication is very ineffective.

Figure 7: *Fall 2023 Frequency that Students Check Their Emails at FIT*

Graph 6 below displays the frequency in which the representative population of students check their emails.



Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

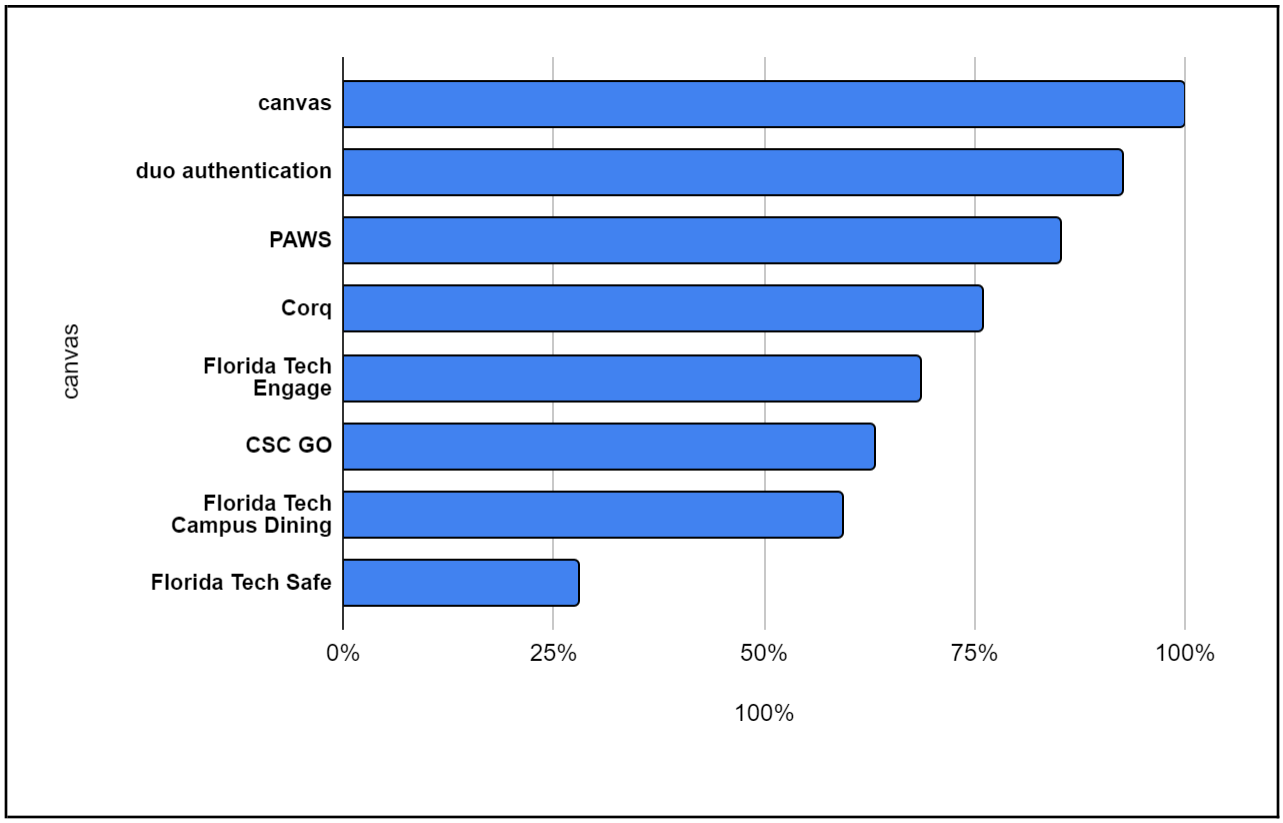
Graph 6 above displays the frequency in which the representative population of students check their emails. 64.8% of representative students check their emails multiple times per day. 20.4% of students check their emails only once a day. 9.3% of students taking the questionnaire check their emails multiple times per week. 5.6% of students check their emails only once a week.

2.5 - Student Application Use and Preferences

Students taking the questionnaire were presented with a list of applications used by the Florida Institute of Technology and asked to check all applications that they have used while attending FIT. The results below are indicative of the students' responses.

Figure 8: *Fall 2023 Student Percent Application Usage at FIT*

Graph 7 below displays the most used applications at the Florida Institute of Technology and the percentage of students who took the questionnaire that used these applications.

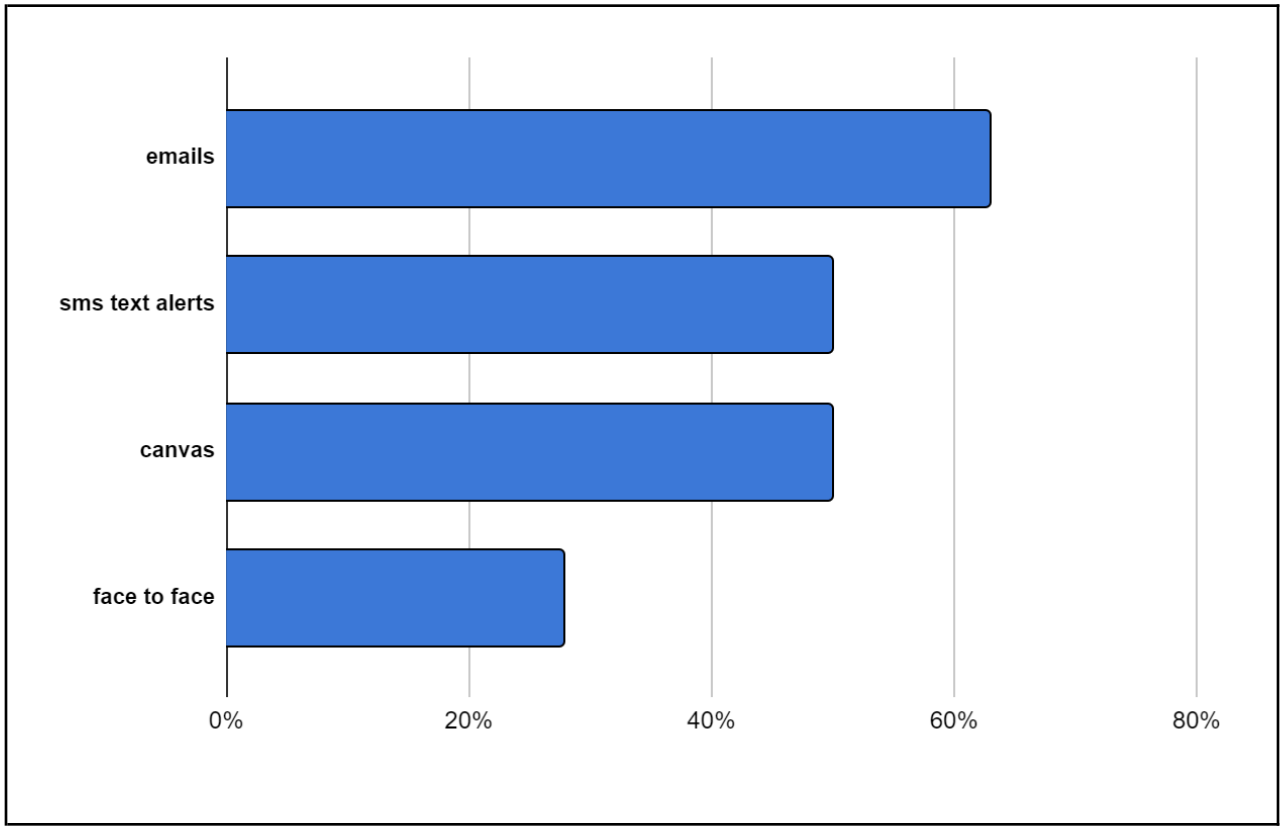


Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, “Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey”. Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

An outstanding 100% of representative students utilize the application *CANVAS.* 92.6% of students who took the questionnaire use *Duo Authentication*. 85.2% of students that participated in the questionnaire utilized *PAWS.* 75.9% of students use the *Corq* application. 68.5% of questionnaire respondents have used *Florida Tech Engage.* 63% of the representative students voted to use *CSC GO.* 59.3% of students utilize the application *Florida Tech Campus Dining*. 27.8% of students make use of the application *Florida Tech Safe.* Over 50% of the representative students utilize at least 7 of 8 applications presented.

Figure 9: *Student Preference of Application for Time-Sensitive Information at FIT*

Graph 8 below shows students preferred application for time sensitive information from administration.



Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, “Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey”. Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

63% of students preferred email for time-sensitive administrative communication. 50% of students preferred both CANVAS and SMS text alerts for time sensitive communication from administration. Only 27.8% of students preferred face to face communication for time sensitive administrative concerns.

3.1 - Email Communication Conclusions

At the start of this report, the problem being researched was categorized as simply communication issues between students and administration. Current data now indicates it is not that simple and there are larger underlying problems. Identifying the main problem will help generate the best and most effective recommendation.

42.3% of students that participated in the questionnaire found email communication at the Florida Institute of Technology to be somewhat effective. Another 36.6% of representative students saw email communication to be some level of effective. Only 21.1% of students saw email communication to be ineffective even at varying levels. When students were asked to identify the biggest problems with email communication the two highest voted answers were unnecessary emails and excessive emails at 73.3% and 57.8% respectively. Only 20% of students felt emails were poorly written and a lower 17.8% of students felt emails do not contain enough information [2.3].

The current email system seems to be preferred by students and the majority of the population believe it is an efficient system. Students were also asked to select their preferred platform for time-sensitive information and a majority 63% of students voted for email [2.4].

If the use of email itself for communication is not a problem, then the utilization of the email system should be evaluated.

73.3% of students voted that unnecessary emails are the biggest problem with the email system. 57.8% of students also felt that there are excessive emails. Students did not seem to find email formatting and information quality to be an issue with less than 30% of students voting in those categories [2.3]. 64.8% of representative students check their emails multiple times per day. Another 20.4% of students check their emails at least once a day [2.3]. Unnecessary and excessive emails seem to be causing problems for a student population that checks and engages in the email system frequently.

3.2 - Application Overuse Conclusions

One of the investigative sections of this report is the use or overuse of applications that might convolute and complicate administrative, staff, and student communication. Data now indicates a definitive problem with the use of applications at the Florida Institute of Technology.

100% of students that participated in the questionnaire used CANVAS. 92.6% of representative students also have used Duo Authentication. Over 75% of participating students utilized both PAWS and Corq. Over 50% of students that partook in the questionnaire used Florida Tech Engage, Florida Tech Campus Dining, and CSC GO. The least voted for and used app provided, Florida Tech Safe, sat around 27.8% of student utilization. Over 50% of students that took the questionnaire utilized 7 or more apps for the Florida Institute of Technology. Many of these apps, like Florida Tech Campus Dining or Florida Tech Safe, could be integrated into another application. Many of these applications also involve cross communication from administration, faculty, and staff all in one.

3.3 - General Administrative Communication Conclusions

This report's main subject is communication, specifically regarding administration. Before coming to a recommendation, opinions, and data of the general opinion about administrative communication at FIT should be evaluated.

51.8% of students who participated in the questionnaire found general communication at FIT to be somewhat effective, another 22.1% of students found it to be slightly effective. Only 14.9% of representative students felt general communication from administration was ineffective. Over 70% of students felt that time-sensitive communication from administration was satisfactory. A much lower 25.5% found time-sensitive communication to be unsatisfactory. One student has this to say about general communication, "I like how email and CANVAS are the most reliable way to contact the people with the speed of being able to connect to them."

The majority of representative students find general administrative communication, time-sensitive or not, to be adequate and sometimes satisfactory. The current system for communication involving email and CANVAS is preferred by students who participated in the questionnaire with 63% voting email as the preferred application with CANVAS second at 50% [2.4].

4.1 - Recommendations

***Figure 10**: Decision Matrix*

Figure 10 below outlines the filled-out decision matrix ACE uses to determine the best recommendation.

Criteria and Weight		Options					
		SMS Texting System		3-Step System		Wayfinder	
Criterion	Weight	Rating	Score	Rating	Score	Rating	Score
Student Preference	3	8 7 8	24 21 24	9 9 10	27 27 30	2 4 5	6 12 15
Ease of Use	1	10 10 9	10 10 9	9 9 9	9 9 9	2 3 4	2 3 4
Ease of Implementation	2	10 10 10	20 20 20	10 9 9	20 18 18	5 4 5	10 8 10
Total			158		167		70

We, as a group, have finalized the decision to recommend the implementation of the 3-step system. This involves the creation of an SMS texting system, adding admin functionality within the CANVAS app, and improvements made to emails sent from campus administrators. We chose to implement this system due to a variety of factors, including implementation cost, the preferences expressed by the student body at FIT, and how easy it would be for students to adjust to and learn the new system.

100% of the students that took our questionnaire expressed that they use the CANVAS app in some way during their studies at FIT. Additionally, 50% elected that they would like some sort of implementation of administrative alerts within CANVAS. Due to the high use case of CANVAS, coupled with the high percentage of users that would like CANVAS to include admin alerts, this implementation is both highly preferred by students and easy for them to learn.

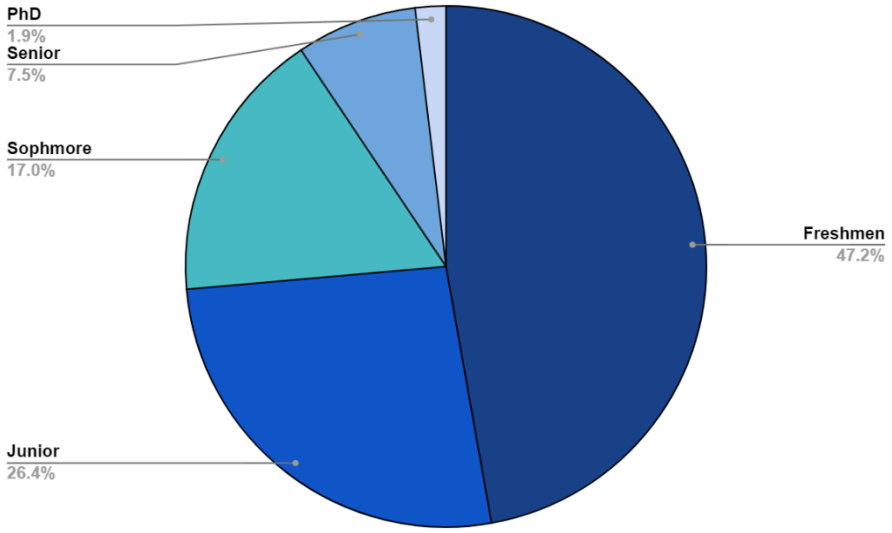
In terms of changes to how administrators communicate via email, there are several key points that need reformation in order to make communication to the student body as clear and easy to understand as possible. One response, "less 'spam' emails that clutter inboxes, teachers/administration don't even see students' emails at times because of this.", highlights many of the shortcomings of the current state of the FIT campus email system. Many other students shared similar sentiments with the aforementioned quote, with a few common problems repeated throughout the responses. The most common complaints by far were that the email system is too cluttered, and that the titles of emails are often confusing and poorly worded. The first of these issues can be addressed by reducing the number of emails that are included in the basic mailing list. What this means is by default, the student email should prioritize exclusively important campus alerts. Extra alerts not seen as priority such as event notifications, job opportunities, and other non-important information should be optional and instead require the student to agree to be sent these extra alerts. As for improving the email system to make it clearer, administrators should be using a format that is easily identifiable among the crowd of emails. This would allow students to instantly identify which emails are from admin, and more importantly give them a preface as to whether it is urgent or not. as

Finally, an SMS texting system would benefit the student body due to the high likelihood of admin alerts being seen in a timely manner. It is shown that 90% of SMS messages are opened within three minutes of being sent (Henion, 2021). That, coupled with the fact that 50% of polled students voted that they would like an SMS texting system shows that having such a system in place for admin to utilize would ensure that they can reach the student body in a much faster manner than they can through the current system of email. This ensures that any time-sensitive or otherwise urgent information is almost certain to be seen, making the communicative process easier for both the administrative and student body.

5.1 - Conclusion

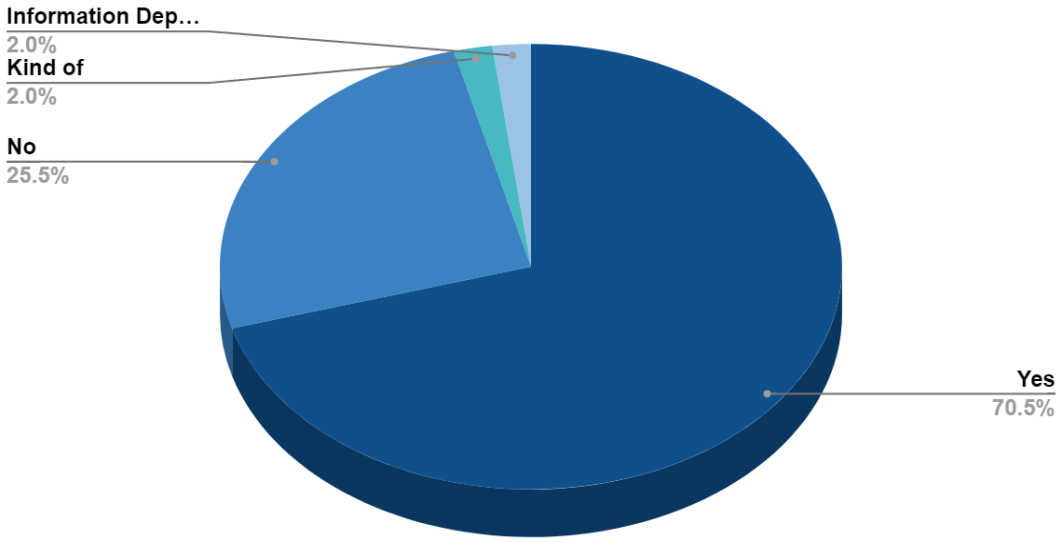
This study sought to highlight and identify administrative communication issues, within the Florida Institute of Technology, that can add to students and administrators everyday stress and even cause feelings of alienation. This comprehensive study identified multiple issues with the current communication system, including email clutter, application overuse, and inconsistent communication while drafting and proposing a recommended solution to the problems identified. Although complications and drawbacks complicated this study. A lack of necessary student respondents during research and an unexpected majority student opinion highlights some of the shortcomings of this report. After analysis of all data the proposed recommendation was a 3-step system addressing the major problems found during the research stages. It is worth noting that the communication issues identified at the Florida Institute of Technology may extend beyond the institution, reflecting broader challenges in universities across the United States. The study underscores the crucial role of digital communication in society and emphasizes the need to promptly address these problems due to their potential lasting impact on individuals' daily lives. Throughout this study ACE learned a great deal about communication and the implications of bad communication. Digital communication has evolved into a fundamental aspect of society, often taken for granted. Its influence extends to schools, workplaces, and homes globally, and it should not be underestimated. Ineffectual digital communication can have enduring and significant consequences on individuals and their daily routines. It is imperative to promptly address issues related to digital communication. Take the time to understand poor digital communication practices to determine if you are impacted by or contributing to adverse digital communication.

Appendix A: Fall 2023 Student Classification of Representative Student Population at FIT



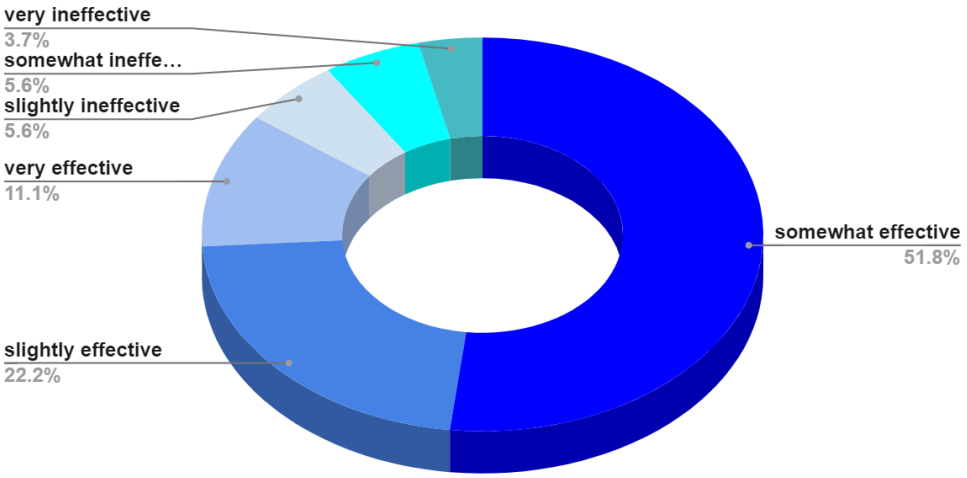
Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Appendix B: Fall 2023 Student Opinion on Time-Sensitive Administrative Communication at FIT



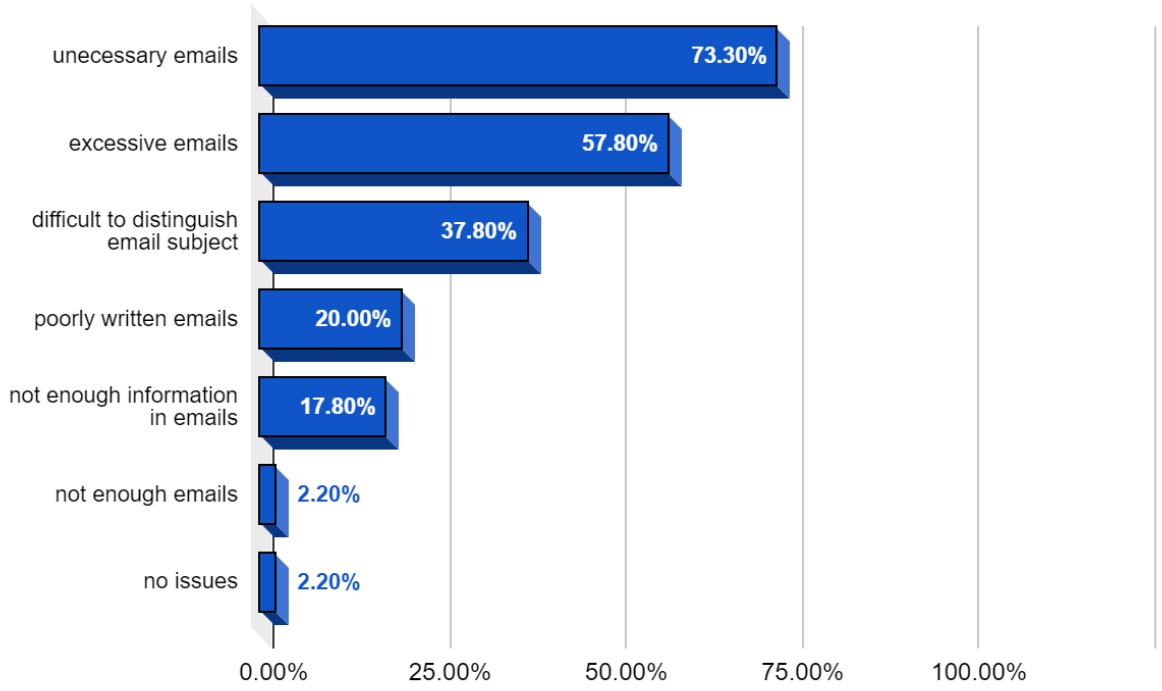
Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Appendix C: Fall 2023 Student Perspective on General Communication at FIT



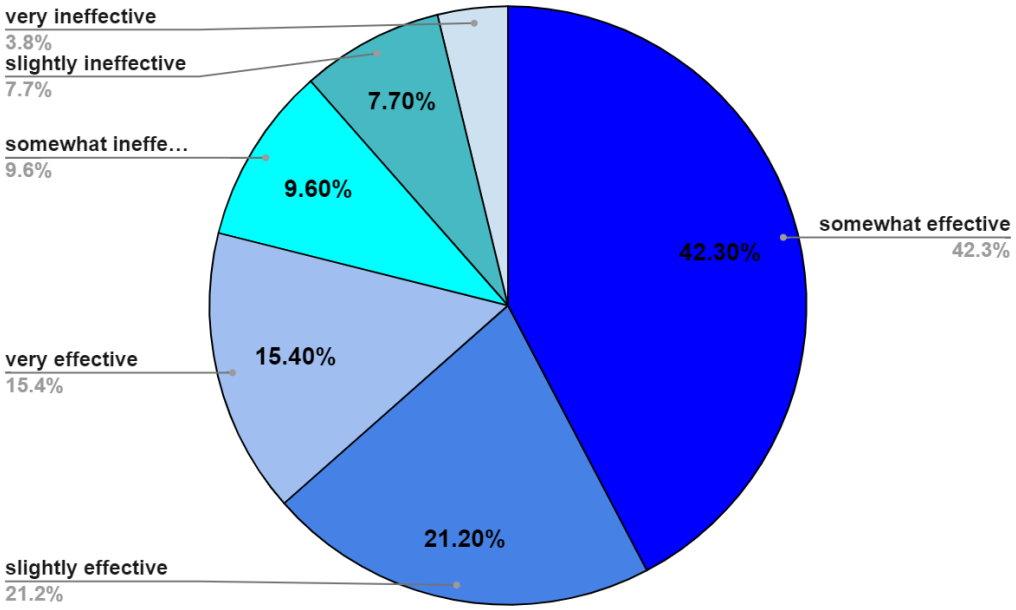
Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Appendix D: Fall 2023 Student Opinion of Administrative Email Problems at FIT



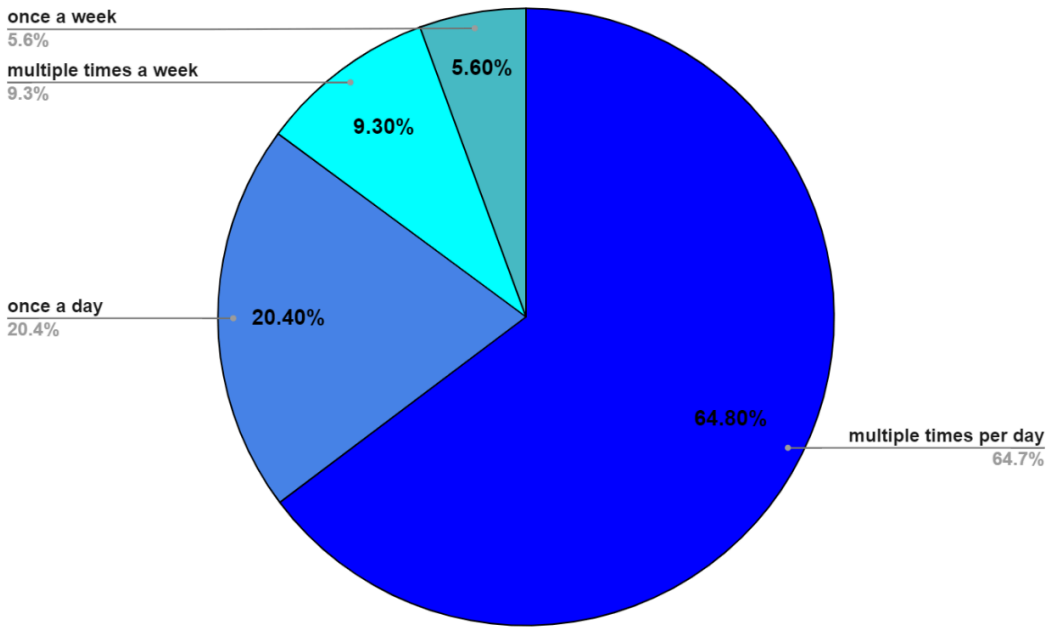
Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Appendix E: Fall 2023 Student Opinion on General Email Communication at FIT



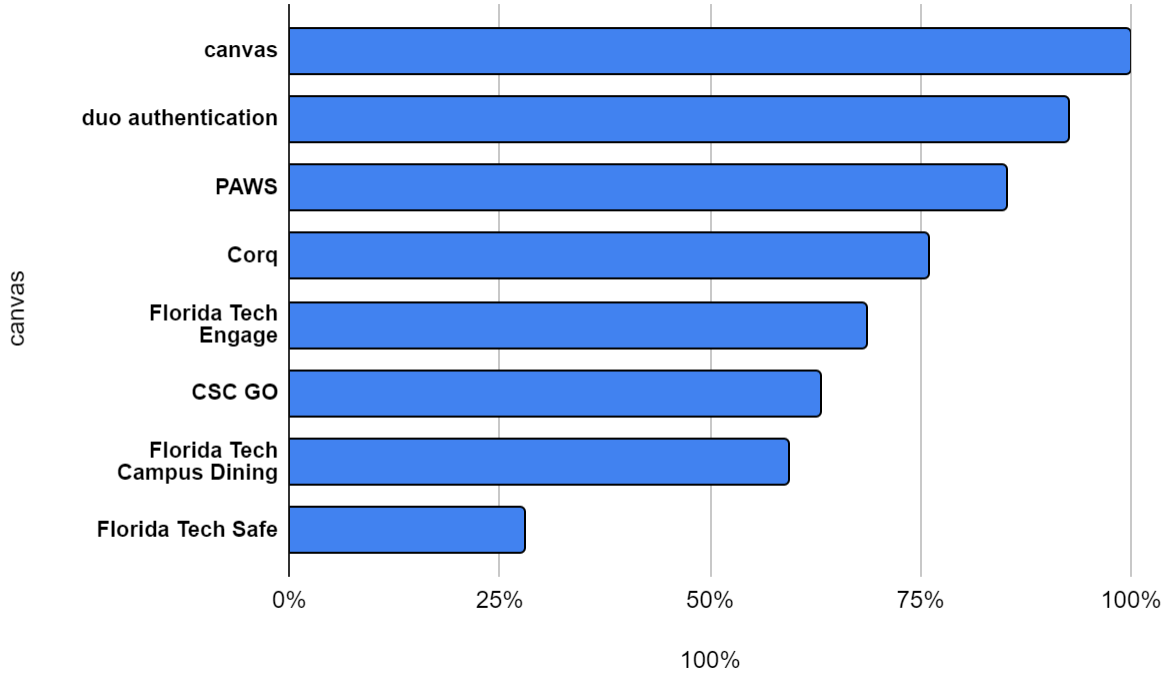
Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Appendix F: Fall 2023 Frequency that Students Check Their Emails at FIT



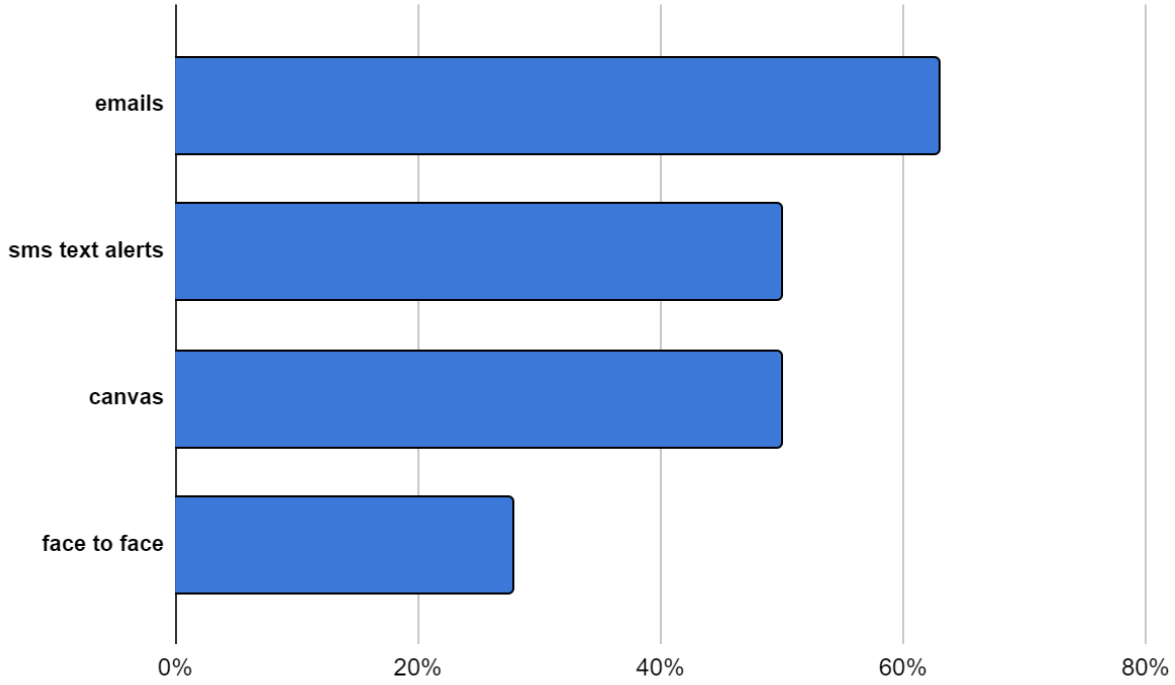
Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Appendix G: Fall 2023 Student Percent Application Usage at FIT



Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, "Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey". Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Appendix H: Student Preference of Application for Time-Sensitive



Schwantes, Sophia, et. al, “Florida Institute of Technology Digital Communication Survey”. Questionnaire. 30th. October. 2023.

Appendix I: Empty Decision Matrix

Criteria and Weight		Options					
		SMS Texting System		3-Step System		Wayfinder	
Criterion	Weight	Rating	Score	Rating	Score	Rating	Score
Student Preference	3						
Ease of Use	1						
Ease of Implementation	2						
Total							

Appendix J: Decision Matrix

Criteria and Weight		Options					
		SMS Texting System		3-Step System		Wayfinder	
Criterion	Weight	Rating	Score	Rating	Score	Rating	Score
		8	24	9	27	2	6
		7	21	9	27	4	12
Student Preference	3	8	24	10	30	5	15
		10	10	9	9	2	2
		10	10	9	9	3	3
Ease of Use	1	9	9	9	9	4	4
		10	20	10	20	5	10
Ease of		10	20	9	18	4	8
Implementation	2	10	20	9	18	5	10
Total			158		167		70

Appendix K: Meeting Minutes

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 1 Agenda and Discussion:* 08/29/23
Time: 8:14 am – 8:50 am
Location: Crawford Building, room 620.
Roles and Responsibilities

Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu

The secretary tasks include; correspondence between the team and the supervisor, recording a typed report of the group's discussion from each meeting, alerting individuals when strikes have been issued, and providing a shared document of discussion highlights that is accessible to every teammate.

Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu

Team leader duties comprise of; creating a clear agenda for each meeting, starting each meeting with a collective aim that is applicable to all team members, clarifying project objectives in an efficient and effective manner, initiating group votes, and summarizing the information discussed at the meeting.

Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu

The coordinator role covers; keeping an organized schedule, providing a timeline for project goals, adapting the project outline in the case of unforeseen circumstances, and ensuring the decision-making and discussion stay within the bounds of the project.

Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu

The graphic designer deals with the aesthetic of the project by; providing eye-catching and relevant data, designing a logical layout, filtering out irrelevant and monotonous information, visually communicating the core ideas of the project, and appealing to the target audience.

Prospective Topic

The issue our team has decided to research and analyze is physical and digital communication between campus/school and student. Our team has identified a lack of guidance from symbols and signs that make navigating the campus difficult for new students. The lack of signs on campus does not limit itself to physical communication but also digital. Throughout the school there is an absence of clear and concise digital contact between students and the university. This does not only apply to academics but also campus extracurriculars. Our goal as a team is to find solutions and mitigate these issues to aid the overall population of staff and students.

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Strike System

- Strike one results in a warning, administered by the secretary or supporting personnel, through Microsoft Teams
- Strike two results in a follow-up warning accompanied by notification sent to the instructor
- Strike three and further on will result in the other members assuming the responsibility of said member and consequences against their final grade will result

Causes for a strike:

- Failing to turn in portion of the assignment at the team due date
- Missing a team meeting without notice
- Not participating in team collaborations
- When a strike occurs, members will be notified via email, where records will be kept via Microsoft teams, and relayed to the instructor if necessary

Unexpected Circumstance:

- An unexpected circumstance qualifies as any immediate issue that demands urgent attention and conflicts with a meeting, assignment due date, or any other team activity
- For an unexpected circumstance to not result in a strike, immediate notice must be given to all team members and reviewal of missed material must be self-initiated (I.e., reaching out to other members, reviewing discussion notes, completing independent research, etc.)
- In the case of absent member, present members will evenly split the responsibilities of absent member amongst themselves

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 2 Agenda and Discussion:* 09/01/23
Time: 8:35am – 8:50am
Location: Crawford Building, Room 620.

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Facilitate completion of meeting minutes assignment and begin proposal research / outline.
- Establish proposal headings and begin secondary research

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 3 Agenda and Discussion:* 09/01/23
Time: 3:00 pm – 3:50 pm
Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Final touches to meeting minutes assignment
- Discussion of plan to complete proposal rough draft
- Discussion and further elaboration of chosen topic
- Formulation of questions for professor for next class period

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 4 Agenda and Discussion:* 09/15/23
Time: 3:30 pm – 4:30 pm
Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Continuing and facilitating completion of AI generated content Assignment
- Creating and outlining group presentation of AI generated content
- Discussing proposal rough draft, due date, and facilitation
- Revisions to summary and memo headings of proposal
- Delegation of secondary research subtasks

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 5 Agenda and Discussion:* 09/18/23
Time: 2:00 pm – 3:15 pm
Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu

Agenda

- Revising AI generated information and paragraphs for usability in research proposal
- Discussing and clarifying team confusion on formatting
- Establishment of subtasks 1.1,1.2 and 1.3
- Finishing advertisement revision assignment ahead of due date

Note

- Formatting of proposal confusion not fully resolved further questions and meeting needed
- Early leave notice [Approved]: Secretary Carter Luellen exited meeting early at 3:00 pm for reasons of tutoring appointment.

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams

- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 6 Agenda and Discussion:* 09/22/23
Time: 8:00 am – 8:50 am
Location: virtual meeting

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Redefining purpose and subject statement
- Working with professor for solution to formatting problems
- Establishing solutions to secondary research subtasks
- Sorting out citation errors

Note

- Purpose and summary statements not fully revised / confusion about difference between statements
- Uncertainty with call to action

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 7 Agenda and Discussion:* 09/25/23
Time: 8:00 am – 8:50 am
Location: virtual meeting

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu

Agenda

- Facilitate completion of proposal rough draft
- Sort out problems with purpose and subject statements
- Establish headings and further timeframes for proposal headings 2-5
- Final touches to secondary research and major revision of task 1.1

Note

- Last second revision to make 1.1 descriptive without a solution causing flow issues for proposal
- Call to action still uncertain

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 8 Agenda and Discussion:* 09/27/23
Time: 3:00 pm – 4:30 pm
Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu

Agenda

- Finishing credentials appendix and Gantt chart
- Cleaning up advanced organizer and abstract
- Discussion of further assignments

Note

- Early Leave notice [Approved]: Team Leader Sophia Schwantes exited meeting at 3:30 pm for reasons of Chemistry Lab Meeting

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior

- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 9 Agenda and Discussion: 10*/03/23
Time: 4:00 pm – 5:00 pm
Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Finalizing subject and purpose statements ahead of proposal final draft
- Minor Gantt chart revisions
- Reviewing subtasks 1.1,1.2,1.3 and 1.4
- Proof-reading report

Note

- Minor confusion on solution location in subtasks, 1.1 present without solution.

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 10 Agenda and Discussion: 10*/04/23
Time: 8:15 am – 8:50 am
Location: Crawford Building, room 620.

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Final questions ahead of submission brought up to professor
- Glossary established
- More proof-reading
- Discussion and facilitation of submission

Note

- team went back through report highlighting words present in glossary

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 11 Agenda and Discussion: 10*/11/23
Time: 8:25 am – 8:50 am
Location: Crawford Building, room 620.

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Creation of 3 types of graphics for assignment and presentation
- Style and color graphics based on style sheet
- Discuss timeframes and further meetings for completion of graphics and PowerPoint

Note

-

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 12 Agenda and Discussion: 10*/12/23
Time: 3:30 pm – 5:00 pm
Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu

Agenda

- Revising graphics created for graphics assignment
- Creation of group PowerPoint for presentation of graphics
- Review of selected research for graphics for use in recommendation report
- Sorting references and speaking order for presentation

Note

- Early leave notice [Approved]: Secretary Carter Luellen exited the meeting at 4:00 pm for matters of chemistry tutoring.
- Caption references for graphics were unclear and generated some uncertainty

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 13 Agenda and Discussion: 10*/18/23
Time: 8:15 am – 8:50 am
Location: Crawford Building, room 620.

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Discussion of team dynamics and previous completions
- Discussion of upcoming progress report
- Facilitating further changes to proposal
- Discussion of recommendation report and outline formation

Note

- There was confusion on if the progress report was a group or individual assignment
- Confusion resolved before end of meeting, progress report is individual assignment

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 14 Agenda and Discussion: 10*/20/23
Time: 3:00 pm – 4:00 pm
Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Further discussion of progress report and cross-referencing to make sure dates and timeframes on progress report are correct
- Referring to and reviewing Gantt chart for future assignments

- Initial discussion and beginning formulating questionnaire

Note

- 2 members of group 3 could not be present for this meeting [Approved]:
- Secretary Carter Luellen for reasons of: Overlapping Chemistry Lab
- Graphic Designer Nick Jacobson for reasons of: pre-planned meeting with engineering group

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 15 Agenda and Discussion: 10*/26/23
Time: 2:00 pm – 3:00 pm
Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities

Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu

Agenda

- Continue building and revising questionnaire
- Establish consistent keywords in questionnaire
- Aim above 10 questions with 2 short answers

Note

- Above 10 questions achieved
- Error when sent externally, likely settings issue, discussion with professor tomorrow

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue

- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 16 Agenda and Discussion: 11*/03/23
Time: 8:00 am – 8:50 am
Location: Crawford Building, room 620.

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu

Agenda

- Review progress report feedback and presentation feedback
- Discuss timeframe and plan to complete recommendation report
- Discussion of distribution of questionnaire
- Review recommendation report progress and facilitation with professor
- Final review and release of questionnaire

Note

- Confusion regarding formatting and headings of recommendation report present
- Formatting and heading confusion resolved, refer style sheet for formatting, headings sorted with professor

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Group 3 Meeting Minutes

Date: *Meeting 17 Agenda and Discussion: 11*/13/23
Time: 3:00 pm – 4:45 pm

Location: Evans Library

Roles and Responsibilities
Secretary – Carter Luellen – cluellen2023@my.fit.edu
Team Leader – Sophia Schwantes – sschwantes2023@my.fit.edu
Coordinator – Zander Burns – zburns2023@my.fit.edu
Graphic Designer – Nick Jacobson – njacobson2023@my.fit.edu
Agenda

- Further discussion of recommendation report and timeframe for completion
- Discussion of delegation of work
- Work on repurposing components of proposal
- Evaluation of current questionnaire data

Note

- 1 member of group 3 could not be present for this meeting:
- Coordinator Zander Burns could not be present for reasons of overlapping Bio Lab

Team Policies

Meeting Procedures:

- All meetings outside of COM 2223 will be held at the Evans Library- notice of team meetings will be posted one week prior
- Agenda of team meeting will be shared to all members via email 24 hours before the day of the meeting
- The team leader will begin meeting with a short recap from prior meeting and discussion/delegation of project tasks will ensue
- Time will be set aside for voting when applicable to meeting
- Meeting will be summarized, and establishment of next meeting will be made

Communication:

- Team communication will operate via Microsoft Teams
- All members will have equal opportunity to voice their opinions and beliefs inside of each project and assignment

Appendix L: References

Albalawi, Hanan, and Muhammad Nadeem. "Exploring the Impact of Ineffective Formal Communication between Teachers and Students: A Case Study of Mustaqbal University and Jubail University College, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia." *ERIC*, 13 Feb. 2020, portal.lib.fit.edu/login?url=https://search.ebscohost.com/login.aspx?direct=true&db=eric&AN=EJ1245110&site=ehost-live.

B. B. Wiyono, D. E. Kusumaningrum, T. Triwiyanto, R. B. Sumarsono, A. V. Valdez and I. Gunawan, "Comparative analysis of using communication technology and direct techniques in building school public relation", *Proceedings 5th International Conference on Education and Technology*, pp. 81-86, October 3-5, 2019.

Gizir, Sidika, and Hasan Simsek. "Communication in an Academic Context - Higher Education." SpringerLink, Kluwer Academic Publishers, 2005, link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s10734-004-6349-x.

"How We Started and Where We Are Today." *Google*, about.google/intl/ALL_us/our-story/. Accessed 21 Sept. 2023.

Henion, Dani. "Texting for Schools & Education: School SMS Service: Simpletexting." SMS Marketing & Text Marketing Services, 29 Sept. 2023, simpletexting.com/guide/text-messaging-for-schools/.

Kuryan, Maria, and Elena Voronina. "Out-of-Class Communication: Are Students and Faculty Interested and Engaged? (A Study at a Russian University)." *EBSCO*, 7 Sept. 2020, portal.lib.fit.edu/login?url=https://search.ebscohost.com/login.aspx?direct=true&db=eric&AN=EJ1299651&site=ehost-live.

Ludwig, Mark. “Digital Management and More: The Top 9 Benefits of an Interactive Campus Map.” *Concept3D*, 13 June 2023, concept3d.com/blog/campus-map/top-9-benefits-interactive-campus-map/.

Musheke, Mukelabai M., and Jackson Phiri. “The Effects of Effective Communication on Organizational Performance Based on the Systems Theory.” *SCIRP*, Scientific Research Publishing, 22 Feb. 2021, www.scirp.org/journal/paperinformation.aspx?paperid=107818.

Naresh Kumar Agarwal & Harrison Lawrence (2014) Office Location Map of Individuals in the Library and Other College Campus Buildings: A Proof-of-Concept Wayfinding System, Journal of Web Librarianship, 8:3, 305-323, DOI: 10.1080/19322909.2014.927744

“Online Tools for Teaching & Learning.” *Online Tools for Teaching Learning*, University of Massachusetts Amherst, blogs.umass.edu/onlinetools/community-centered-tools/google-classroom/#:~:text=Google%20Classroom%20is%20a%20free,release%20on%20August%2012%2C%202014. Accessed 21 Sept. 2023.

Pate, Adam, et al. “Impact of Communication Method and Timeliness on Student and Faculty Perception of Professionalism and Value.” *American Journal of Pharmaceutical Education*, Feb. 2022. https://www.aacpajpe.org/article/S0002-9459(23)01409-2/fulltext.

Spevack, Max. “The Origins of E-Mail.” *The Origins of E-Mail*, cs.stanford.edu/people/eroberts/courses/soco/projects/1999-00/internet/email.html. Accessed 21 Sept. 2023.

Wesel, Lisa. "University Facilities Planners Prioritize New Construction and Renovations." *Tradeline, Inc.*, 28 Apr. 2021, www.tradelineinc.com/reports/2021-4/university-facilities-planners-prioritize-new-construction-and-renovations.

Wiyono, Bambang Budi, et al. "Use of Online Communication Media as A Student Learning Tool in College and Its Effect on the Achievement of Students." *2020 6th International Conference on Education and Technology (ICET), Education and Technology (ICET), 2020 6th International Conference On*, Oct. 2020, pp. 186–91. *EBSCOhost*, https://doi.org/10.1109/ICET51153.2020.9276562.

Appendix M: Glossary

Digital Communication - the use of online tools like email, text messaging, or social media to reach individuals or an audience to share a message with them.

EFL - Economics for Leaders program.

FIT – Florida Institute of Technology

OCC - Out-of-Class-Communication.

SMS – Short Message Service

Wayfinder – Wayfinder intends to help not just students, staff and faculty, but also anyone visiting the campus by creating an interactive campus map that can be utilized by any audience. This, in turn, helps alleviate some of the stressors of navigating a new environment by saving time and confusion with precise campus locations

Canvas – An interactive software designed to assist professors and their students by utilizing the digital space to give assignments, map out course plans, and grade students while creating an easy to navigate software for students to properly understand their course, assignments, and syllabus.

Alienation - the state or experience of being isolated from a group or an activity to which one should belong, or in which one should be involved.

ACE – Stands for: "Active Communication Efficiencies." This is the title of Group 3 conducting this research study.

Appendix N: Gantt Chart

Tasks	**Date of Tasks (by Week of Dates)**								
Task 1 - Secondary Research									
Task 1.1 - Lack of Communication + Solution									
Task 1.2 - Email Preference Study + Solution									
Task 1.3 - Overutilization of Apps + Solution									
Task 1.4 - Summary of Solutions / Overview									
Task 2 - Primary Research									
Task 3 - Data Evaluation									
Task 3.1 - Chart/Graphics Formation									
Task 3.2 - Secondary Research Comparison									
Task 3.2.1 - Highlight Major Differences									
Task 4 - Progress Report									
Task 5 - Recommendation Report									
Task 5.1 - Recommendation Report Draft									
Task 5.2 - Evaluate and Edit Feedback									
Task 5.3 - Finalize and Print Report									
Task 6 - Oral Presentation									
Task 6.1 - Creation of the PPT									
Task 6.2 - Presentation Rehearsal									
	9th	16th	23rd	30th	6th	13th	20th	27th	4th
	Oct.				**Nov.**				**Dec.**